

PRODUCT TEARDOWN

Subspace.money

5 Product Feedbacks — Vocallabs.ai Product Intern Assignment 2026

Subspace.money is India's first subscription management + group sharing platform. This teardown is based on direct usage of the Android app — sign-up, exploration of Public Groups, My Subscriptions, Home dashboard, Gift Card Marketplace, and the Group Joining flow.

#1 UX — Onboarding drops new users into confusion	
(a) Observed	After signing up, I was taken directly to the 'Public Groups' screen with no introduction, tooltip, or explanation of what Public Groups means or how the app works. There was no onboarding walkthrough, no 'here's what you can do' moment. The group joining screen also shows crowded information (ratings, slots, prices, chat icons) with no guidance for a first-time user.
(b) Problem	A new user has no mental model of Subspace's core value prop — subscription sharing, bill splitting, group finance. Without context, they don't know what action to take first. This increases drop-off immediately after sign-up, wasting the acquisition cost. First impressions are especially critical for a fintech app where trust is built slowly.
(c) Ship Instead	Add a 3-screen onboarding flow after sign-up: (1) 'Track all your subscriptions in one place', (2) 'Share plans with friends and save money', (3) 'Split bills without the awkward follow-ups'. Each screen should have one clear CTA. Alternatively, a contextual tooltip overlay on the Home screen explaining each section would cost less to build and still fix the confusion.

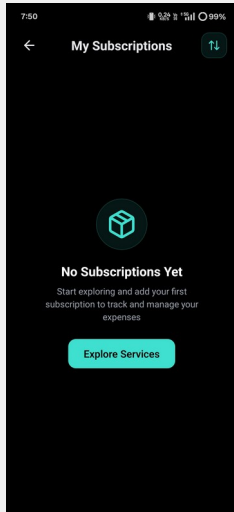
Screenshot Evidence

The screenshot shows the 'Public Groups' screen in the Subspace.money app. It features a search bar at the top, a 'Sort by' dropdown menu set to 'Top Ranked', and a list of subscription groups. Each group entry includes a service logo (e.g., YouTube, Spotify, Netflix), the plan name, price, duration, and the number of groups. A 'Join Group' button is visible for each entry. The interface is clean but lacks onboarding guidance for new users.

#2 Features — No visible auto-detection of existing subscriptions

(a) Observed	When I navigated to 'My Subscriptions', the screen showed 'No Subscriptions Yet' with only a manual 'Explore Services' CTA. There was no prompt or flow to connect bank accounts, UPI, or SMS to auto-detect existing subscriptions like Netflix, Spotify, or Jio that I may already be paying for.
(b) Problem	Subspace's core promise is to help users track and manage subscriptions — but if detection is manual-only, most users won't bother adding them. People don't remember all their recurring charges. Auto-detection via SMS parsing or UPI statement analysis is the exact hook that creates the 'wow, I didn't know I was paying for this' moment — the app's biggest retention driver. Without it being front and center, the product feels like a directory, not a personal finance tool.
(c) Ship Instead	On the empty 'My Subscriptions' screen, add a prominent banner: 'Connect your UPI/bank to auto-detect your subscriptions'. Use SMS read permission (with clear consent) or UPI statement import to surface existing recurring charges automatically. This mirrors what CRED and Fi do well. Even a manual quick-add of 'top 5 most common subscriptions' as tappable chips would reduce friction significantly.

Screenshot Evidence

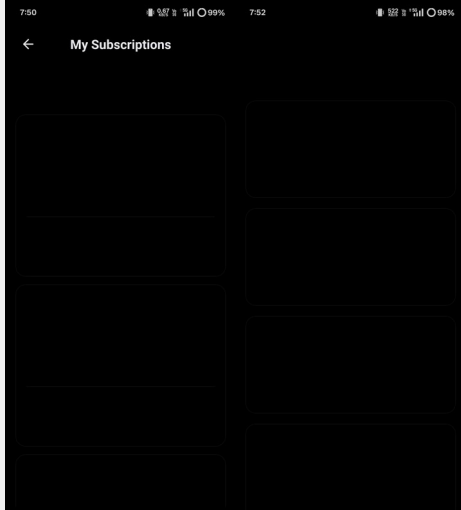


#3 UX — Multiple screens fail to load (blank black cards)

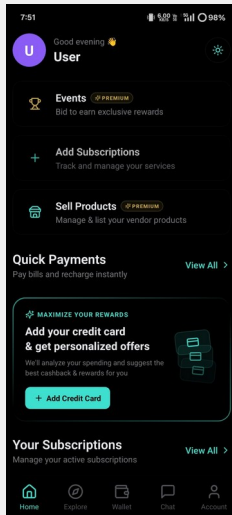
(a) Observed	On two separate occasions — 'My Subscriptions' (7:50 AM) and the Explore section (7:52 AM) — the screen showed large blank black card-shaped placeholders with no content, no loading spinner, and no error message. I had to wait and re-navigate to get content to appear.
(b) Problem	Blank black loading states with no feedback create anxiety in a fintech app. Users immediately wonder if something broke, if their data is lost, or if the app is safe to trust with their payment info. For an app that asks users to connect credit cards and share subscription access, trust is everything. A broken loading state — even for 10 seconds — is disproportionately damaging to perceived reliability.
(c) Ship	Replace blank card skeletons with animated shimmer/skeleton loaders that clearly

Instead	communicate 'content is loading'. Add a timeout fallback: if content doesn't load in 5 seconds, show a friendly message ('Taking longer than usual — tap to retry') with a retry button. This is a standard pattern in apps like Zepto, CRED, and Swiggy and takes minimal engineering effort to implement.
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Screenshot Evidence



#4 GTM / ICP — Home dashboard is cluttered and unfocused for core users	
(a) Observed	The Home screen shows: a greeting, 'Events (Premium)', 'Add Subscriptions', 'Sell Products (Premium)', 'Quick Payments', a credit card upsell banner, and 'Your Subscriptions' — all above the fold. 'Sell Products' especially felt completely out of place for a user who came to manage subscriptions.
(b) Problem	The home screen is trying to serve too many user types at once — subscribers, vendors, premium users — resulting in a diluted first experience for the core ICP (a young Indian consumer managing 3-5 subscriptions and splitting costs with friends). When everything is prominent, nothing is. The 'Sell Products' feature signals the app isn't sure who it's for — which reduces confidence in the product's focus.
(c) Ship Instead	Segment the Home screen by user type. For a standard user with no subscriptions yet, show: (1) a clear prompt to add their first subscription, (2) a 'Join a group and save' CTA with a sample saving amount, and (3) Quick Payments. Hide 'Sell Products' from non-vendor users entirely or move it to the Account tab. Premium features can be surfaced in a non-intrusive 'Upgrade' tab.
Screenshot Evidence	



#5 Competitor / Collaboration — Gift card savings are too small to drive behaviour

(a) Observed

The Explore/Gift Cards section shows discounts like: Flipkart ₹196 for ₹200 (1.5% off), Croma ₹981 for ₹1000 (2% off), PhonePe voucher ₹99.65 for ₹100 (0.35% off). These are negligible savings that would not motivate a user to change their purchase behaviour or return to the app.

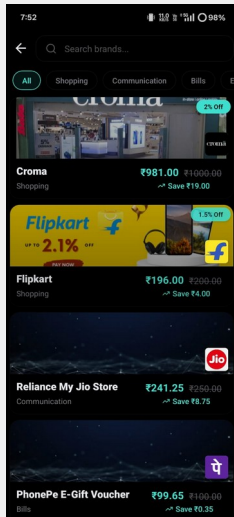
(b) Problem

Subspace's gift card marketplace is competing with CRED Coins, Amazon Pay cashback, and credit card reward programs — all of which offer 2-5%+ effective returns. A 0.35% discount on a PhonePe voucher gives users zero reason to route purchases through Subspace. If the marketplace doesn't deliver clear, tangible value, it becomes shelf-ware — users open it once, feel underwhelmed, and never return.

(c) Ship Instead

Partner with 3-5 high-frequency brands (Swiggy, Zomato, BookMyShow, MakeMyTrip) to offer exclusive 5-10% discounts for Subspace users — positioning this as a 'members-only' benefit. Bundle savings: 'Buy ₹500 in gift cards this month and get ₹50 Subspace credits' creates a loyalty loop that drives repeat visits and increases GMV.

Screenshot Evidence



Prioritisation Note

If I were to prioritise these 5 for immediate shipping, the order would be: (2) Auto-detection first — it is the core value unlock and biggest retention driver. (3) Loading states — quick engineering fix, disproportionate trust impact. (1) Onboarding — reduces Day-1 drop-off. (4) Dashboard cleanup — improves clarity for core ICP. (5) Gift card partnerships — longer-term BD work but high strategic value.

All observations are based on direct usage of the Subspace Android app on 31 May 2026.